

The Road's Bestiary

A Lazy GM's Reference
for Fate's Edge

Ink cut with ash and rain. No ninth entry.

How to Use This Manual

- **Monsters** are built from **Harm levels** (1–3) and optional **clocks** (4–8 segments). No HP math.
- Each entry includes **Danger**, **Harm**, **Clocks**, **Tags**, and a **Fate's Edge twist**.
- **Lazy GM Table** (p.4) lets you roll any adversary in 10 seconds.
- **Character Inspiration** (p.5): draw two playing cards to generate a random concept + complication.

Monsters & Adversaries

The Hollowed Stag (Forest Omen)

A stag with antlers of bleached bone, ribs visible through translucent hide. It never eats. It only walks.

Danger 2 (lone)

Harm 3

Clocks *Silent Approach* [4] – when ticks, the stag appears behind someone.

Tags [BEAST] [SPIRIT] [DREAD]

Twist It does not attack first. It *watches*. If you flee, the clock advances. If you stand still, it passes. If you offer a memory, it is forgotten.

The Ragged Piper (Fen Spirit)

A drowned man in patched wool, playing a reed pipe that sounds like children laughing.

Danger 3 (with swarm)

Harm 2

Clocks *The Dance* [6] – when full, all in earshot must follow the piper for one tick.

Tags [SPIRIT] [CONTROL] [AUDIO]

Twist Immune to steel. To banish, offer a truth the piper has forgotten.

The Boiler-Wight (Aeler Ruin Guardian)

A brass-and-copper construct, furnace heart, steam for breath. Hisses the names of intruders.

Danger 4 (ambush)

Harm 3

Clocks *Overpressure* [4] – each tick adds +1 Harm to its next action.

Tags [CONSTRUCT] [FIRE] [WARDEN]

Twist Ignores anyone carrying a stamped Aeler work order. Cries out the names of the dead.

The Silt-Fisher (Coastal Horror)

A long pale arm emerging from tidal mud, fingers webbed, dragging things below.

Danger 2

Harm 2

Clocks *Tug* [3] – each tick pulls a victim one step closer to the water.

Tags [AQUATIC] [GRAB]

Twist Can be reasoned with if offered a drowned coin or a son's name.

The Star-Masked (High Pass Cultist)

Face obscured by a tarnished silver mask etched with constellations that change.

Danger 3 (with 2 followers)

Harm 2

Clocks *Omen* [6] – each tick, a star falls. At 6, the cultist knows the future.

Tags [HUMANOID] [OCCULT]

Twist Cannot be harmed by the same weapon twice. Worships the stars.

The Mourner's Candle (Haunting)

A single wax candle burning with a blue flame. No wick. No smoke. It whispers.

Danger 1 (environmental)

Harm 1 (chill)

Clocks *The Mourner* [4] – when full, the candle cries hot wax, igniting the floor.

Tags [UNDEAD] [FIRE] [TRAP]

Twist Extinguishing it requires a broken copper knife. The dead are not forgotten.

The Brick-King (Street-Tough's Bane)

A seven-foot figure of crumbling mortar and cobblestones, crowned with a rusted signpost.

Danger 4

Harm 3

Clocks Collapse [6] – each time it takes Harm, tick once. At 6, it crumbles into difficult terrain.

Tags [CONSTRUCT] [IMMOBILE]

Twist Cannot enter a building without an invitation. Will parley if you offer a new signpost crown (any metal pole).

The Umbral Hound (Shadow Wolf)

A sleek black canine with no eyes, only star-shaped voids. Its growl silences all sound.

Danger 3 (pack: +1 per extra hound)

Harm 2

Clocks Night Hunt [3] – at full, the hound phases through walls to attack from an unexpected direction.

Tags [BEAST] [SPIRIT] [STEALTH]

Twist Cannot abide direct sunlight. In darkness, it gains +1 to Harm.

Lazy GM Adversary Table

Roll 2d6 or pick. All stats are Cap-based. Harm = 3 unless noted.

2d6	Type	Body	Key Skill	Twist
2	Starving Scavenger	2	Brawl 2	Fights only for food; flees if fed
3	Deserting Soldier	2	Melee 2	Carries a sealed letter (story hook)
4	Witch-Hunter Acolyte	2	Lore 2	Has a bell that reveals illusion
5	Road-Wearry Trader	1	Sway 2	Knows a shortcut; Harm = 2 only
6	Hedge Thug	2	Stealth 1	Uses nets and grappling hooks
7	Mad Prophet	1	Command 2	Clock: shouts true omens; Harm = 2
8	Poacher	2	Ranged 2	Carries a rare animal (valuable trophy)
9	River Pirate	2	Athletics 2	Has a foe on a pleasure wreck
10	Corrupt Cleric	2	Resolve 2	Ward of Belding (use prayer)
11	Fae-Touched Rider	3	Ride 2	Move has [PHASE] tag; Harm = 2
12	Guardian Statue	3	Melee 3	Summar; collapses only if hit with heavy hits. At 6, terrain becomes difficult

To use: Add the adversary to the scene. Set Position and DV per core rules. Use Cap for assist dice if they have followers.

Character Inspiration: Two Cards

At character creation or when introducing a new NPC, draw two playing cards (suit + rank). Combine a **Concept** (Heart/Diamond) with a **Complication** (Spade/Club). No jokers.

Concepts (Heart or Diamond)		Concept
Rank	Concept	Rank
2–3	Exiled noble	2–3
4–5	Grizzled scout	4–5
6–7	Street-wise fixer	6–7
8–9	Failed scholar	8–9
10–J	Faith healer	10–J
Q–K	Retired soldier	Q–K
A	Last of a bloodline	A

Then roll or pick a third card for a **Goal** (any suit):

- **Red (Heart/Diamond):** Protect someone or find a treasure.
- **Black (Spade/Club):** the story has a choice – the hound will avenge an insult.
- **Ace:** discover the truth about [a place, death, or omen].

Example: 6 (Grizzled scout) + 8 (Secretly ill) + Q (avenge an insult) = a sick tracker who wants revenge on the poacher who killed her mentor.

Quick Clocks for Monster Encounters

Use these clocks as secondary objectives during fights	Clock	Trigger / Effect
Knows a shortcut; Harm = 2 only	Summar	Shouts true omens; Harm = 2
Carries a rare animal (valuable trophy)	Carries a rare animal (valuable trophy)	Each round word ticks. At 4, reinforcements arrive
Has a foe on a pleasure wreck	Has a foe on a pleasure wreck	Monster stops fighting to drain a victim
Ward of Belding (use prayer)	Ward of Belding (use prayer)	Monsters can tick by using a specific skill
Move has [PHASE] tag; Harm = 2	Move has [PHASE] tag; Harm = 2	Threat when an ally falls. At 4, all enemies move
Summar; collapses only if hit with heavy hits. At 6, terrain becomes difficult	Summar; collapses only if hit with heavy hits. At 6, terrain becomes difficult	At 6, terrain becomes difficult
Dawn (8)	Dawn (8)	Vampiric / shadow creatures weaken

Final Notes for the Lazy GM

- You never need to invent a monster from scratch. Use the table above and rename.
- For a **leader-type**, add a clock that summons minions. For a **swarm**, treat as a zone hazard (test to avoid Harm each turn).
- Fate's Edge monsters are not sacks of HP. They have **twists** – use them to create choices, not just fights.

- When a player says "I know this creature," let them roll Lore. On success, they invent one of its tags (subject to your veto).

The road does not forgive a missed roll. It only reschedules it.
— Dusana of the Raven Road (apocryphal)

Aeler – Tunnel Brigand

A dust-caked dwarf with a pick-handle and a grudge against under-market assessors.

Cap 2 (Body 2, Melee 1, Athletics 1)
Harm 2
Clocks *Alarm Bell [4]* – ticks if fight lasts more than 2 rounds. At 4, a player times.
Tags [HUMANOID] [UNDERGROUND]
Twist Will parley if offered a better paying job. Knows one shortcut through the Underways.

Aelinnel – Thorn Hedge-Snatcher

A gnome with copper-tipped fingers, hiding in hawthorn, stealing way-cords.

Cap 2 (Wits 2, Stealth 2)
Harm 1 (nonlethal – just wants your beads)
Clocks *Knot Unravel [3]* – each tick, loses one of your non-essential items.
Tags [HUMANOID] [FAE-TOUCHED]
Twist Cannot be struck with iron. Apologize in couplets and they will return your way-cords.

Aelaerem – Hollow-Fond Redcap

A halfling in a bloodstained smock, crouching at a cup-mark stone, demanding butter or breath.

Cap 2 (Body 2, Brawl 2)
Harm 2
Clocks *Hollow Tithe [4]* – each demand refused ticks. At 4, the Neighbors notice.
Tags [HUMANOID] [THRESHOLD]
Twist Instantly defeated by a hot loaf of bread or a lit lantern.

Lethai-al – Root-Warden Poacher

A wood elf with moss-tattooed hands, illegally harvesting moon-sap.

Cap 3 (Wits 3, Stealth 2, Survival 1)
Harm 2
Clocks *Called Hunt [6]* – ticks when he wounds. At 6, a Lethai-al warden arrives.
Tags [HUMANOID] [FOREST]
Twist Will trade stolen moon-sap (heals 1 Fatigue, but causes visions) for safe passage out of the woods.

Lethai-thora – Scriptorium Cutpurse

A high elf with ink-stained sleeves, lifting scrolls from the Archive of Keys.

Cap 2 (Wits 2, Deception 2)
Harm 1 (flees if blood drawn)
Clocks *Seal Broken [4]* – ticks if he fails a theft. At 4, the archivists notice.
Tags [HUMANOID] [URBAN]
Twist Carries a stolen page that holds a forgotten spell (Free Cords)

Lethai-ar – Masked Enforcer

A dark elf wearing a blank porcelain mask, carrying a silk cord.

Cap 3 (Spirit 3, Command 2, Melee 1)
Harm 2
Clocks *Oath Binding [4]* – ticks when she speaks. At 4, one PC is bound.
Tags [HUMANOID] [OCCULT]
Twist Her mask is her witness. Smash it and she loses all social graces.

Yknu – Horse Thief of the Violet Steppe

An orc with braided beard, leading a string of ponies with altered brands.

Cap 3 (Body 3, Ride 2, Survival 1)
Harm 3
Clocks *Remount Call [5]* – ticks each round. At 5, he whistles a new horse.
Tags [HUMANOID] [MOUNTED]
Twist Will abandon the fight if you offer a better horse. Knows one shortcut through the Underways.

Vilkari – Foedus Road Levyman

A dwarf with a polished chainmail, demanding an illegal toll at a stone bridge.

Cap 2 (Body 2, Melee 2)
Harm 2
Clocks *Patrol Recall [4]* – ticks if toll refused. At 4, a mounted soldier arrives.
Tags [HUMANOID] [LAW-ADJACENT]
Twist Actually has a genuine but expired writ. If you help him, he'll return your way-cords.

Phara – Oasis Water-Sharpener

A sun-baked trader who sells you the same waterskin twice, with a smile like cracked leather.

Cap 2 (Presence 2, Sway 2)
Harm 1 (nonlethal – he runs)
Clocks *Well Poisoning Rumor [6]* – ticks each time he lies. At 6, the Neighbors notice.
Tags [HUMANOID] [DESERT]
Twist Actually knows where a true cistern is – will trade the location for safe passage out of the woods.

Sidhi – Coastal Quay-Bruiser

A tanned, rope-calloused woman with a keatted visor, protecting a smuggler's cove.

Cap 3 (Body 3, Melee 2, Survival 1)
Harm 2
Clocks *Called Hunt [6]* – ticks when she wounds. At 6, a Lethai-al warden arrives.
Tags [HUMANOID] [FOREST]
Twist Will trade stolen moon-sap (heals 1 Fatigue, but causes visions) for safe passage out of the woods.

Cap 2 (Body 2, Brawl 2)
Harm 2
Clocks *Tide Returns* [4] – ticks each round. At 4, water rises, making the footing unstable.
Tags [HUMANOID] [COASTAL]
Twist Loyal to a lighthouse keeper’s daughter. Mention her name and the bruiser steps aside.

Generic Mundane Monsters (Culture-Neutral)

No folklore, just the common beast you’d find anywhere – with a Fate’s Edge twist.

Pereshi – High Pass Toll-Jumper

A hooded figure with a notched staff, demanding a “breath tax” at a windy col.
Cap 2 (Spirit 2, Lore 1)
Harm 1 (curses, not cuts)
Clocks *Wind Remembers* [5] – ticks each time you refuse. At 5, the pass closes for 1d3 days.
Tags [HUMANOID] [MOUNTAIN]
Twist Actually a harmless pilgrim seeking alms. Recite a verse correctly and he’ll guide you to free.

Cave Lurker (Aeler / Ubral)

A pale, eyeless, long-limbed thing that clicks to see.
Cap 2 (Body 2, Melee 2)
Harm 2
Clocks *Echolocation Lock* [3] – ticks when you make noise. At 3, it knows where you are.
Tags [BEAST] [CAVE]
Twist Deafened by ringing a bell. Will not pursue beyond the sound.

Marsh Stilt-Walker (Mistlands / Theona)

A heron-like creature with a too-long neck that watches from the reeds.
Cap 2 (Wits 2, Stealth 2)
Harm 1 (sharp beak)
Clocks *Stolen Reflection* [4] – each time it strikes, it steals a mirror.
Tags [BEAST] [AQUATIC]
Twist If you toss a copper coin into the water, it will retrieve it.

Dhaharan – Monsoon Footpad

A rain-soaked bandit with a stitched eye, lurking near jade caravans.
Cap 2 (Body 2, Stealth 2)
Harm 2
Clocks *Storm Front* [4] – ticks each time he attacks. At 4, a sudden downpour gives him cover.
Tags [HUMANOID] [JUNGLE]
Twist Carries a jade charm that absorbs one Fatigue (once).

Steppe Bone-Wolf (Ykrul / Vilikari)

A gaunt, grey wolf with ribs showing, running in silent packs.
Cap 3 (pack of 3, each Body 2, Brawl 1)
Harm 2
Clocks *Surround* [4] – ticks each round. At 4, pack gains +1 die.
Tags [BEAST] [PACK]
Twist Will not attack a rider who carries a foal’s tail. Can be lured.

Lazy GM Table: Random Cultural Adversary

Roll d12 for culture, then d6 for a generic foe. All use Cap 2–3, Harm 2, and a twist.

d12	Culture	Typical Foe	
1	Aeler	Tunnel Brigand (pickaxe)	<i>A six-legged lizard with chitinous plates, nesting in fallen statues.</i>
2	Aelinnel	Thorn Hedge-Snatcher (knot thief)	Cap 2 (Body 2, Climb 2)
3	Aelaerem	Hollow-Fond Redcap (demanding butter)	Harm 1 (claw)
4	Lethai-al	Root-Warden Poacher (moon-sap)	Clocks <i>Egg Cache</i> [5] – ticks when it flees. At 5, it returns with eggs.
5	Lethai-thora	Scriptorium Cutpurse (scrolls)	Tags [BEAST] [RUIN]
6	Lethai-ar	Masked Enforcer (silk cord)	Twist Afraid of fire. Also afraid of anything that speaks in proper.
7	Ykrul	Horse-Thief	
	(altered brands)		
8	Vilikari	Foedus Road Levyman (illegal toll)	<i>A pale, child-sized figure that stands at the edge of lamplight. Never blinks.</i>
9	Fhara	Oasis Water-Sharpener (false water)	Cap 1 (no combat)
10	Sidhi	Coastal Quay-Bruiser (knotted clubs)	0 – it lures, not harms
11	Pereshi	High Pass Toll-Jumper (breath tax)	Clocks <i>Follow</i> [6] – ticks each time someone looks away. At 6, a path appears.
12	Dhaharan	Monsoon Footpad (jade charm)	Tags [SPIRIT] [TRAP]
			Twist It is not malicious – it is lost. Speak your true name to it.

Night Bait (Any Rural Area)

Quick Character Inspiration by Culture (Two Cards)

Extending the previous table – draw two cards, add cultural flavor.

Concept (Heart/Diamond)		Complication (Spade/Club)	
<i>Rank</i>	<i>Concept</i>	<i>Rank</i>	<i>Complication</i>
2-3	Escaped bond-servant	2-3	Branded by an old master
4-5	Canal boat pilot	4-5	Lost a valuable cargo
6-7	Relic auctioneer	6-7	Owe a favor to a Masked Enforcer
8-9	Bell-warden's apprentice	8-9	Secretly tone-deaf (cant fail a bell test)
10-J	Salt-pan worker	10-J	Carries a pox scar that itches near spirits
Q-K	Caravan guard	Q-K	Saw a Hollow Bride and ran – branded a coward
A	Last heir of a fallen house	A	A mirror shows your face as someone else

Then add culture: Roll or choose a culture from the Lazy GM table. That culture shapes the adversary's appearance, tools, and the name of their faction.